

Kathleen Mack Statement 9/29/20

COVID restrictions have created difficulty throughout the landscape of education

Back in August, the district was faced with a choice to enter into a full five-day return, choose a hybrid return, or stay remote. On the county Corona virus heat map, the district was still in the red zone. In August, I felt that it was essential to look at two components: the virus data for Brecksville- Broadview Heights and the educational and psychological impact of not returning to school. Based on that criteria, I chose a five-day return. Our cities had a low incidence of coronavirus cases, and the educational and psychological impact was beginning to compound to an uncomfortable level. At that time, I stated that it was necessary to give parents, teachers, and students a choice: return for five days and provide a robust online platform. Unfortunately, the majority of this board did not agree, only Mr. Dosen.

So now, in late September, the board is presented with a recommendation from our Superintendent to go to what I believed was the best course in August: a five-day model or an online model. The majority of the parents agree that the educational/psychological impact has been too significant for some students. For those parents online, I am hopeful that the majority of this board recognizes that the creation of this midway model (hybrid) is hurting your choice. Everybody is losing. There cannot be equity in education without delivering an all in or all out model.

Our educators in this district have worked hard to adjust to a hybrid model that, in my opinion, is not sustainable. The longer this model continues, the more it compounds. The missing assignments continue to pile up for some students, and the educational gaps continue to grow. I hope the rest of this board, which are not the academic experts, allow our Superintendent's recommendations and the majority of our parents to hold weight in their decision making. Permitting your fears and biases to get in the way is not fair to all the people who elected you to represent them.